



RICHARDS, FRANKLIN

Son of Reed and Sue Richards of the FANTASTIC FOUR, Franklin Richards was once one of the most powerful mutants on Earth. Before his birth, strange energies flowing through Sue's body nearly killed both mother and baby until ANNIHILUS' Cosmic Control Rod suppressed them. AGATHA HARKNESS acted as Franklin's nanny in his earliest years. The boy soon began to exhibit immense psionic powers. Using his ability to see possible futures, he became a member of POWER PACK under the name Tattletale. Nathaniel Richards, his grandfather, later raised him in a realm outside of time, where he became the adult adventurer Psi-Lord, and founded the Fantastic Force before Hyperstorm erased his adult form from existence. When the AVENGERS and the Fantastic Four seemingly perished fighting ONSLAUGHT, Franklin sent them to a "Counter-Earth" of his own creation. He used his powers to bring back GALACTUS and return his sister Valeria to his mother's womb, but lost his powers in the process. Recently, Franklin helped the THING and the HUMAN TORCH escape the Negative Zone during the Secret Invasion (see pp. 326-7). **DW, MF**



The enemies of the Fantastic Four have frequently made Franklin the target of their aggression.

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Franklin Benjamin Richards

OCCUPATION

Occasional adventurer

BASE

New York City

HEIGHT

4 ft 8 in

WEIGHT

100 lbs

EYES

Blue

HAIR

Blond

FIRST APPEARANCE

Fantastic Four Annual #6 (1968)

Formerly possessed vast powers of telepathy and telekinesis, as well as the ability to fire psionic blasts, reshape reality, appear in astral form, and perceive future events.

RICHARDS, FRANKLIN

POWERS



Peter Parker as Ricochet, wearing a costume designed by his partner, the fashion-conscious Mary Jane.

RICOCHET

When SPIDER-MAN was falsely accused of murder, a \$5 million reward was placed on his head and he was forced to adopt a new identity in order to find the real killer. Instead of temporarily assuming one new persona, he created four: RICOCHET, DUSK, HORNET, and PRODIGY. After clearing his name, Spider-Man discarded these identities and their costumes. The costumes came into the possession of a former Super Hero called the

Black Marvel, who gave them to four teenagers and formed a new super-team called the Slingers. One of the members was Johnny Gallo, a troubled youth who had grown apart from his father after his mother was killed in a car accident. Johnny literally leaped at the chance to use his mutant powers in the Slingers, but like the other members of the team he was disillusioned when it emerged that the Black Marvel had obtained the costumes from MEPHISTO. Nevertheless, the Slingers battled to save the Black Marvel's soul from Mephisto and won, although the battle claimed the life of the Black Marvel. The Slingers then disbanded and Gallo moved to Los Angeles. He joined a group of former teenage heroes who were adjusting to civilian life and trying to dissuade other teenagers from becoming costumed heroes. **TD**



FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Jonathon "Johnny" Gallo

OCCUPATION

College student

BASE

Los Angeles, California; formerly Brooklyn, New York

HEIGHT

5 ft 10 in

WEIGHT

155 lbs

EYES

Blue

HAIR

Blond

FIRST APPEARANCE

Slingers #0 (as Johnny Gallo, December 1998)

Mutant with superhuman leaping, acrobatic, and gymnastic skills. Possesses a "danger sense," similar to Spider-Man's "spider-sense." Also uses throwing disks as weapons.

Ricochet can use his throwing disks to shatter opposing weaponry and stun his foes

RICOCHET

POWERS